Evidence III: Future Match Reversal (Table 3)

If a wrestler wins because his opponent threw the match, the opponent must be compensated.

- **Mechanism: payment in kind**
  - Cash leaves a paper trail
  - A future win is 'inside the arena' is harder to prove
- **Prediction**
  - After winning on the bubble, wrestler should lose more often vs. the same opponent next time
  - But only for winners, losers on the bubble show no reversal
- **Result**
  - **Winners on the bubble: ~8 pp more likely to lose the next meeting**
  - Losers on the bubble: no significant reversal (−5.6 pp, n.s.)
- **~⅔ of all excess bubble wins are returned in the very next meeting**
- Suggests cash payments also exist — one future loss is too cheap to be the whole compensation

TABLE 3—WIN PERCENTAGES IN PRECEDING AND SUBSEQUENT MATCHES
(For Two Wrestlers Who Meet When One is on the Margin in the Final Three Days of a Tournament)

	All Matches on the Margin		Only Matches in Which the Wrestler on the Margin Wins		Only Matches in Which the Wrestler on the Margin Loses	
Variable	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
One or two matches prior to the bubble match	−0.002 (0.009)	0.005 (0.012)	0.020 (0.011)	0.019 (0.017)	−0.041 (0.016)	−0.035 (0.022)
Bubble match	0.151 (0.010)	0.164 (0.014)	—	—	—	—
First meeting after bubble match	−0.073 (0.011)	−0.062 (0.015)	−0.082 (0.015)	−0.079 (0.020)	−0.056 (0.020)	−0.040 (0.027)
Second meeting after bubble match	−0.002 (0.013)	0.005 (0.016)	0.031 (0.017)	0.028 (0.022)	−0.061 (0.023)	−0.039 (0.030)
Three or more meetings after bubble match	−0.010 (0.006)	0.012 (0.011)	0.013 (0.007)	0.022 (0.014)	−0.045 (0.008)	−0.013 (0.017)
Constant	0.500 (0.000)	—	0.500 (0.000)	—	0.500 (0.000)	—
Wrestler-opponent interactions?	No	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes
R^2	0.008	0.271	0.002	0.279	0.002	0.279

Asymmetry: Only winners on the bubble show the subsequent reversal — exactly what a repayment mechanism predicts. Effort cannot explain this.